



The Search is Over: Missing Bird Found!

By: Diarmuid Murphy, Bryce Kanter, Ayden Kanter

Rain fell hard, pattering on the shingles of the gymnasium. All were gone, but a single janitor. *ScreEeeeeEEch*. The sound of the broken wheels on Stanley's cleaning cart reverberated throughout the room. He grabbed his mop out of his bucket of cleaning solution and went to work, moving it back and forth across the hardwood floor.

Stanley looked up from the ground, squinting to see the clock. It read 8:57 PM. He scurried across the gym, cleaning up any dirty spots. Then, Stanley reached into his cart, pulling out a sign that read 'Caution, Slippery Ground' and set it down.

On the other side of campus, something mischievous was going down. A lone figure, out of breath, had just staggered up the hill that York is perched upon.

Vroom Vroom. Stanley revved the golf cart engine, put the pedal to the metal, and sped off across York School, hitting only one flower pot (maybe two). He returned his cleaning supplies to the janitor's closet in the science building.

Five minutes later, he was driving home.

The lone figure, let's call him Charles for the time being, was still recovering from the hard trek up York hill, with his hands on his knees and gasping for air. Once recovered, Charles started towards the chapel, where he used his master key to unlock the doors. He glanced around him to ensure that no one was watching. As he opened the double doors of the chapel, he threw back his head and began to cackle menacingly. *MWAHAHA!* For **6 or 7** minutes, Charles stood there, his raspy laugh piercing the air. *MWAHAHA!* Someone else joined him, laughing. Something... He quickly turned his head, but not quickly enough. A turkey shot through the air, charging at Charles and taking him down to the ground. It was a brawl. Charles crawled out of the fight, a changed man, with gashes across his face. Eventually, he made his way into the chapel, looking around for any possible witnesses. Lucky for him, no one was to be seen. "Perfect," Charles said to himself.

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A Note from the Editors

By: Esther Spaulding & Sofía Teresa Mejia Contreras

Hello, York Community!

We're thrilled to kick off the third volume and first issue of the year of The York Oracle! This year marks an exciting new chapter: under the guidance of our new faculty advisor, Ms. Danishako, the paper is now completely student-led. We've welcomed new members from all grades, ensuring that our legacy of storytelling and truth-seeking will continue strong.

We're also doubling our publication frequency, from once a semester to once a quarter so that you can look forward to more updates, insights, and voices from around our community.

As always, our mission remains the same: to keep York informed, connected, and inspired! In this issue, you'll find a variety of stories and features that reflect our collective curiosity and creativity, featuring articles on current events and mysterious disappearances.

Before continuing with the newspaper, we wanted to remind all of you of York's values as we move through the year.

- Be **respectful** of others' views and beliefs. We realize that this is a time of varying political, social, and religious perspectives, and someone else's opinion is theirs to hold. We encourage conversation, not conflict, and if you are sharing your perspective, make sure it's done in a safe and considerate space.
- Be **responsible** by staying informed, staying healthy, and staying sane. Think carefully before choosing your words, stances, and direction.
- Be **compassionate** by showing gratitude, practicing patience, and being mindful of those in our community.
- Lastly, be **honest**. communicate openly, give credit where it's due, and hold yourself accountable.

A huge thank-you to our dedicated newspaper staff, to our faculty advisor Ms. Danishako, and to every member of the York community! Here's to a year of dialogue, heart, and the stone cold truth!

— Esther Spaulding and Sofia Teresa Mejia Contreras

York Events

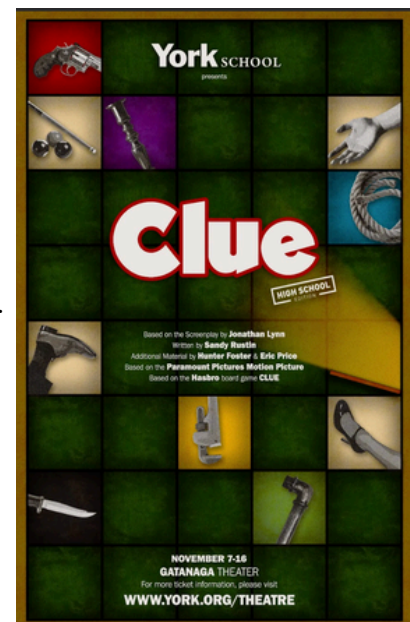
By: Juju Alajjak

Fall is here, and with so many exciting events coming and going, you're definitely not going to want to miss any of them. **Homecoming** and **Spirit Week** have passed, and I hope everyone was able to go. Even if you couldn't go, I'm glad everyone got the chance to participate in Spirit Week! **Fall Fair** has also passed, and all of the clubs and organizations did such a good job with all the booths! Huge highlights were the Jazz Band and the Rock Band performances! There were also a couple of tournaments, raffles, and auctions. **Red and Black Spirit Day** has just passed on October 22nd. Black team won last year, but this year the Red team came and took the victory by 6 points! Everyone was wearing their school spirit and tried their hardest in the games, even if they didn't win.

The **Halloween dance** has just recently passed on the 24th of October. It was so fun to see all the cool and creative costumes at the dance. Please join us in celebrating the spooky season with us by participating in the upcoming **costume contest** on October 31st! Make sure to wear your costume and participate! Winners of each category (Funniest, Scariest, Most Creative, Best Duo, Best Group, and Best Faculty Costume) will win a DoorDash gift card!

Another fall event to look forward to is the infamous play **Clue**. *Clue* will be performed on November 7th-8th from 7-9:30 pm, November 13th-15th from 7-9:30 pm, and then again on November 16th from 2-4:30 pm. Please come and support everyone who has worked so hard to put this performance together.

To finish off the year, we have **Cafe Night**, which will be held on November 21 from 6-8 pm in the library., **Thanksgiving Break** will be from November 26th to 30th. We hope to see you at all the fun events and that you enjoy fall!



YORK SCHOOL FALL SPORTS

Cross Country

By: Ayden Kanter



The season starts with the Brian Rogers Jamboree, the 5th annual and hosted on our very own course, which is notorious for being one of the toughest in the area. With the steep hills and the deep sand throughout, I'm convinced that Mr. Peters designed it this way to slow down the other teams, even though we keep saying it does the same to us...

The boys' race begins first. "Runners, take your marks!" Mr. Peters shouts. Then he sounds his megaphone siren, and over 70 runners from 6 schools stampede across the grass of the York upper field. Ivan Bischoff sprints to the front, rounding the track. Peter Stratton and Diego Silva, el capitán, remain close behind. Everyone starts way too fast, but the adrenaline keeps them going.

The race lasts for around 20-30 minutes, and then the scores are tallied up based on placement. The York boys' team did extremely well, with our top 5 runners as 3rd, 4th, 6th, 9th, and 14th. And, we won this meet for the first time! It was a huge accomplishment to beat schools significantly larger than us, including Stevenson, Monterey, and Seaside—and only two York runners threw up. The girls' race follows soon after. Because there are many other girls' sports during the Fall, it has been difficult to recruit cross

country runners in the past, but we are excited to have 3 girls on the team this year. They are all freshmen, and though it isn't enough for a full team, they are doing extremely well individually. Two girls ran in the first meet and both got under 30 minutes, placing in the top 40% of the race!

Since then, York has had three meets, and has continued their momentum with a 1st place finish at Pinto Lake in Watsonville, a 4th place finish at Toro Park, and a 2nd place finish on our home course.

Only the PCAL championship remains and if we're lucky, there is a chance of qualifying for CCS, both as a team and individually. Best of luck to York XC in the home stretch of the season!

Field Hockey

By: Sofía Teresa Mejia Conteras

It's another great year for York's Field Hockey Team! This year, the field hockey team entered the JV division, rapidly improving their skills and strategies. With a winning record, these Falcons soared to great heights. Captains Xinyao Zhang '25 and Jenna Alaniz '25 will be greatly missed as they graduate this following spring, as well as the beloved Kristin Lee. Though the year is almost over, the team is preparing for one last showdown against Carmel. Let's wish them luck and JOIN FIELD HOCKEY!



Girls Tennis

By: Kayla Lee

Girls' tennis is one of the many sports offered at York. Daphne Liu '28 reported that she joined the team because she thinks that tennis is an interesting sport, and it is her favorite sport. Liu also mentioned that she likes it because she can practice with her teammates.

Another tennis player that we interviewed was Irene Qi '26, who said that she is most excited to play against Oakwood because she thinks that the Oakwood girls' tennis team is really strong. Also, the campus is really pretty and huge. She also said that the courts are really good!

Julie Zhou '26 is another girls' tennis player, and said that her favorite part about playing tennis is the sport in general.

Zhou said that she "fell in love with this sport" and that she also loves how all the girls on the team are so friendly!

Tennis is a really cool sport, and it seems like the season went well for the girls on the tennis team.

Girls Volleyball

By: Mayar Osman



We asked Coach Jamie, the JV girls' coach, what her favorite part of coaching them was. Coach Jamie said that her favorite part was watching them progress and excel in volleyball. She said it was rewarding to see that.

We interviewed some of the girls from the JV team as well. Willow Weisblum '27 reported that her favorite part of playing volleyball on this team was the amount of motivation and kindness the coaches and players display within games & practices. It was really amazing to hear something like that directly from a player.

We also interviewed 2 other girls from the JV team, Nili Biblarz '26 and Yara Ahmed '27, who reported that the season is going well and both teams are starting strong, the hardest part of playing on the team is the long, hard practices (which are worth it by the way), and spiking!

There was no star player chosen this season because all of the players were progressing and working hard at their own pace and in their own way. GO FALCONS!

Water Polo

By: Mr. Steve Peters (via Featured Falcon)

The team shined this season, winning games with only 8 players and a single sub! The following players participated in the Watsonville Tournament with only 8 players and won 1 game and lost 3 competitive games! Kudos to: Sam Clarke, Rowan Fogg, Milana Wilson, Gabe Gonzalez, Lily Trujillo, Amelia Teta, Henry Li, and Julian Jimenez Ortiz.

Food Trucks Review

By: James Brunicardi

From Mexican food to Asian to Barbecue to Pizza, the York School food trucks have it all! So what are you craving today? Is it the crispy pepperoni pizza from Top Shelf Catering-Pizza? Tender barbecue ribs from Chillin' And Grillin'? A divine burrito from Monterey Bay Catering? Or the deluxe orange chicken bowl from Kuki's? Most of the time, it's Kuki's that York students are craving the most.

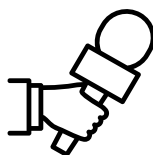
Every Friday during lunch, I find myself in a long line of fellow York students, all excitedly awaiting their lunch. Kuki's is most definitely the most popular food truck at York, but why is that? After interviewing several students and faculty, I've found a few factors that explain its popularity.

The first is the food quality. Kuki's always offers fresh, tasty, and mouthwatering meals every Monday and Friday. The second factor is the wide variety on the menu, including sides, main courses in different sizes, drinks, and desserts. The third factor is the exceptional customer service. The people working the truck are always kind and efficient. These three factors make Kuki's a crowd favorite.

Another favorite is Top Shelf Catering-Pizza, available on Wednesdays. From classic cheese and pepperoni to deluxe options like The Godfather, Top Shelf has something for everyone. Students and faculty appreciate the truck's efficiency, serving meals quickly without compromising quality. Pizzas are always flavorful, crispy, and customizable.

On Mondays, The Monterey Bay Catering Food Truck offers everything from tacos to burgers to fries and desserts. Anytime you're at York on Monday, it's worth visiting for a meal your heart desires.

Finally, Chillin' and Grillin' on Thursdays serves pulled pork sandwiches, black beans, chicken wings, or combos. The food is delicious, though a bit pricey. That's the only drawback; otherwise, it consistently delivers a phenomenal barbecue meal.



Person on the Street: What is your biggest hot take?

By: Sophie Stemerman

"Pineapple does not belong on pizza because I think pineapple tastes really bad." -Dash '30

"I don't like instant noodles because it tastes nasty." -Jaqueline '30

"Good people at this school because they're nice." - Kevin '29

"Stay consistent, stay prepared because you never know what could come at you." -KiKi '29

"My favorite song, because not many people listen to this type of music." -Daphne '28

"I firmly believe that pineapples belong on pizza, and if anyone thinks otherwise, they should go to jail." -Daniel '28

"Robotics, because we don't have a lot of people. Please join Robotics!" -Diarmuid '27

"The spicy hot cheeto puffs with vanilla ice cream, it's so fire." -Willow '27

"Ghanaian jollof rice is better than Nigerian jollof rice." -Ava '26

"I feel like Ariana Grande is overrated. I mean, she's a good singer, I love her, but I think people are a bit too much of a fangirl for her. I feel like there's better artists out there." -Asya '26

New Faculty & Staff at York School

By: Ayden Kanter

Spotlighting two new faculty or staff members each edition.

Dr. Waugh-Reed

Dr. Waugh Reed, our new school counselor, grew up in Washington state. As a teen, she was part of a peer-to-peer support group called Natural Helpers, which led her to want to further pursue counseling and psychology. She moved to New Mexico for college, where she earned a master's in counseling and guidance and a PhD in educational leadership. After spending nearly 30 years in New Mexico working with students on their mental health, she decided to move to the West Coast, and we are happy to have her at our school.

She especially enjoys working with high school students to get the opportunity to hear about their hopes and dreams, and watch them grow. She says, "If you were to sit here and tell me what your hopes and dreams are, and what you're trying to go for, and what your plans are, for me it's so energizing to be some small part of that."

In her free time, Dr. Waugh Reed enjoys spending time in nature, fishing, cooking new recipes, and reading sci-fi. She loves spending time with her boxer, Oakley, and is excited to get to know students at York School.

She says that it is important to seek counseling if you are facing a mental health crisis, but it's also great if you just need a new perspective or want to make a change in your life. Book a meeting with her using the QR or the one outside the main office.



24/7 CALL, TEXT, CHAT



Mr. Toon



Mr. Toon teaches 8th and 9th grade English, as well as a semester-long Debate course. After growing up in SoCal and going to SF State for college, he went to pursue a master's in Linguistics at Cal State Long Beach. However, he felt drawn back to Northern California, and when seeing York School, he fell in love with the school culture.

Mr. Toon also felt a pull to Monterey County because it was the birthplace of John Steinbeck, one of his favorite writers. This year, due to him, the 9th grade class is reading two Steinbeck novels: *The Red Pony*, and *Of Mice and Men*, and loves bringing local authors into the English curriculum.

Additionally, Mr. Toon is co-leading the newly-founded Tabletop Games Club with Matthew Lee, which encompasses board games, card games, dice games, and much more. Some of his favorite tabletop games include *Dungeons of Dragons* and *Warhammer*, and he hopes to play these in the club.

Outside of school, he enjoys playing guitar, riding his motorcycle, and spending time with his cat.

Missing Bird (Continued)

He knew where it was. He strode across the room, right up to the second door. Again, Charles opened the door, but this time, without laughing. He had learned his lesson. Charles seized the mascot costume of York School and left, unnoticed by everyone. This action sent York School spiraling into the biggest mystery of the century.

Around a month into the school year, all had lost hope at finding the missing Perry the Peregrine, except for three brave men: Diarmuid ÓG Murphy, Bryce Kanter, and Ayden Kanter. We have dedicated our lives to solving mysteries like these. When this case arose, we were on it.

So, where to start? We knew that the students and faculty had gone on a schoolwide search, searching every nook and cranny, every closet and attic, and every doorknob and teacup of the school. However, despite the hard work and determination put into the search for Perry, we were left empty-handed.

So where had he gone? Some say that Perry has taken part in a zoo breakout somewhere in the Midwest. Others believe that we will be receiving anonymous photographs in the mail from the birds all around the world. Another, who goes by the exact name of Angad Khera, says that Perry is “up in a tree.” That’s all he said. However, one theory that we heard the most was that Perry was hidden around campus, unintentionally, or daresay even...intentionally. Dramatic music plays. Hearing this, we only developed a stronger passion for saving our beloved Perry the Peregrine, and ultimately, the school’s spirit.

So off we went. We carefully scanned suspect areas of the school, but came up with nothing. We followed people’s leads, from room to room, but never found anything. Until that all changed. On one fateful day, Mr. Paul Mattingly, our savior, assisted Diarmuid in solving the whole enchilada.

As a cool breeze blew Diarmuid’s newly grown-out hair wildly around, Mr. Mattingly helped him search through some shipping containers. They rummaged through the containers, leaving no stone unturned, but no mascot costume emerged. So, via a speedy golf cart, they traveled across campus to the fabled Day Hall. They searched many rooms inside the building, but alas, nothing. Then, they reached Room DH-F. That’s when everything changed.

Room DH-F is currently known as the Student Life Office. The room had previously been a faculty office, but it was now an abandoned mess with barely any space to walk around in. Cobwebs lined the walls, with spiders crawling up and down them, and Diarmuid (a.k.a. Sherlock Holmes) struggled to make his way around. For five minutes, they searched, finding no clues as to where Perry could be. Diarmuid was sad. Diarmuid was depressed. Then, he and Mr. Mattingly saw something. They gasped. Gasp! They gasped again. Gasp! Something was hidden, below several other boxes. Diarmuid carefully removed each box with his toned arms, setting them aside; he was astounded by what he had seen. The glorious costume saw the light of day once again, reuniting us with Perry the Peregrine Falcon at last.

Diarmuid picked it up, embracing it like a newborn baby. His especially attractive brown eyes locked with the falcon’s (still attractive but not as attractive as Diarmuid’s). It was truly a moment to remember. But he quickly realized something important. In order to maintain the secrecy of the discovery, few people could know, so as to make sure that the first issue of the York Oracle was fully enjoyed by the public upon its release.

Diarmuid couldn’t wait to share this discovery with Bryce and Ayden. When they saw it, they began swimming in tears of joy (secretly because they couldn’t reveal what they had found). They were triumphant, jumping up and down.

We are excited and pleased to be able to share this story with you, and hope this was a delightful read. For now, we know he is back at York School, but the question still lingers – could he disappear again?

**Creative liberties were taken to produce this article.*

Special Feature: Paul Mattingly

By: Emory Teta



Have you walked around York and seen our beautiful landscape? Our gorgeous flowers and beautiful pathways trimmed for us to stroll? All this is thanks to one man... Mr. Paul Mattingly. Mr. Mattingly works through the summer past our school's time to make sure our campus is not just suitable, but beautiful for you, York students. He's here before the rest of us and stays past the rest to not only make beautiful signs like the one you see when you first turn into York, but also things that are also less seen around our campus, like cutting back branches so they don't hit you while walking to the student center or your next class, or putting up eco-friendly solar-powered lights to guide us at night on the sidewalks. Mr. Mattingly may work in the shadows, so today we're going to shine some light on him. His bright smile and warm British "hellos" will always make you feel welcome; he's definitely the Hagrid of York School. A warm British fellow who keeps our grounds perfect. Next time you go around campus, look at how lovely it is, really put your phone down and look around, then go tell Mr. Mattingly, "thank you" for all he does.

The Rise of Rock Band

By: Ajay Bakhda

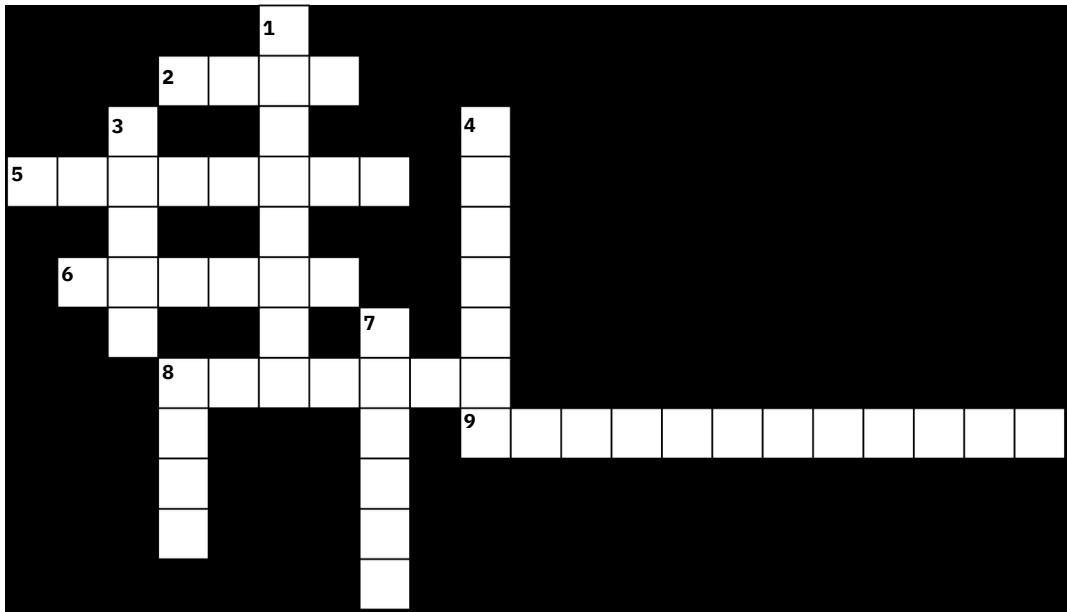
In September of 2024, *The York Rock Band* was announced as an option for Experiential Learning. Chris Lopez, the Rock Band teacher, says the following about the creation of the program, "I wanted to start rock band because I realized that the more options there are for people, [the more people] are gonna find a way into music that they are extra excited about at the front door." He went on to say that he hoped that this experience would inspire others to join other musical endeavors, like orchestra or jazz. However, Rock Band has faced its share of challenges getting off the ground. The first problem was the time slot. Mr. Lopez couldn't use the clubs block because, in his own words, "They only meet for like a half hour, twice a month. So, yes, it's over the course of the whole year, but it's so short of a time that by the time we get set up and get playing, the time is over." Experiential Learning solved this problem with an hour every Friday. Now they also meet on Mondays and A days.

Though the first concert in the 2024-2025 school year was to a smaller audience than anticipated, Mr Lopez remarked that "I would say every ensemble's first concert will pretty much always be a very interesting one." Rock Band had a resurgence earlier this year, when they performed to a full house, and they were the highlight of Fall Fair. At Fall Fair this year, Rock Band debuted a name: NITRATE. They continued to perform at the Hacienda Hay and Feed and are preparing for a performance on Grandparents Day. Mr Lopez says to stay tuned, as this will be their most ambitious concert yet!



Games

Edited by: Veer Bajaj

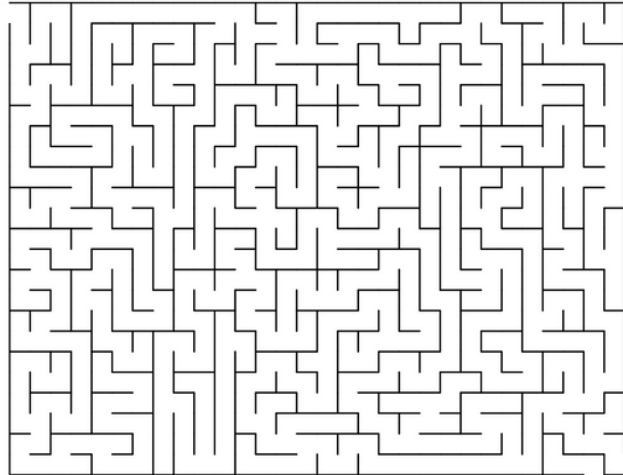
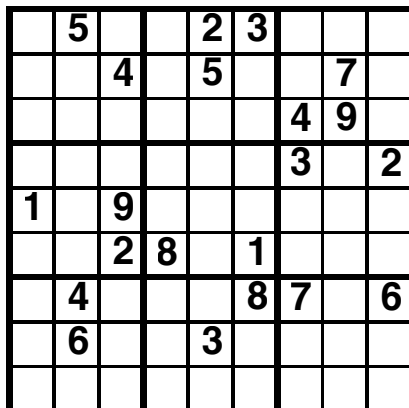


Down

1. Block Five, for most students
3. Name of our assembly
4. "We inspire and prepare a _____ community of creative, independent thinkers."
7. ____ Commons
8. The tortoise's name

Across

2. Ms. Danishanko's Room
5. In between period 4 and 5
6. ____ Family Theatre
8. Our school mascot
9. _____ learning



More games (and answers) [here](#)

Masthead

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